

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM



LaVonnia Noble King lost her friend Jacqueline Reynolds in 2013 when a Chicago police vehicle hit Reynolds while chasing a vehicle driven by Timothy Jones, who was 20. King said of Jones: "He did not hit Jackie. They did. And then they put the whole blame on him." **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

CHA paid \$787K to 9 exiting leaders

Payments made over last 5 years as senior officials left; 2 had received warnings

By Lizzie Kane
Chicago Tribune

Nine Chicago Housing Authority senior leaders received more than \$787,000 collectively in separation agreement payouts over the last five years, including two who had received written warnings from Tracey Scott, the agency's former CEO.

A Tribune analysis of CHA records shows that each of the nine received at least two months of compensation at the salary level they had on their last day of work. Six of the agreements were signed between August 2024 and early March 2025.

CHA "acknowledge(s) the volume of these recent transitions" and is working to "identify inefficiencies within our structure and make decisions that will best support our residents now and in the future," said CHA spokesperson Matthew Aguilar in a statement to the Tribune. CHA did not respond to questions and instead provided the statement, saying it could not comment on specific personnel matters.

CHA has been bleeding staff in recent months, with eight high-ranking officials having left the agency since August, including one who was fired. As it reckons with the departures of these senior leaders and searches for a new CEO, the agency has launched a series of initiatives for 2025, including moves meant to increase housing and safety for residents.

Turn to CHA, Page 3

Bill gives hope to inmates who were young offenders

If it passes, hundreds serving lengthy terms could be eligible for resentencing

By Jeremy Gorner
Chicago Tribune

SPRINGFIELD — Christopher Carter was 20 when he took part in the murder, armed robbery and kidnapping of a man whose body he helped dispose of on Chicago's West Side in March 2001.

He was the youngest of three suspects charged in the crime. He argued that his role was comparatively limited and court records suggest that he didn't commit the actual killing, but at trial testified that he participated in

the crime because he was afraid of the two older men. All three were convicted, and Carter was sentenced to 100 years in prison.

More than 20 years into his incarceration, criminal justice reform advocates say Carter is among roughly 1,200 people in prison in Illinois who, under legislation being considered in Springfield, could be eligible for resentencing by a judge who takes into consideration their age and maturity level at the time the crimes were committed.

The proposal would apply to

people in prison for crimes they committed when they were under 21. It marks one of the latest efforts by lawmakers to allow retroactive sentencing reforms that would give long-term prisoners, some essentially locked away for life, a chance at freedom.

The bill has offered a glimmer of hope for Carter's sister, Latarsha Hobbs, who said she talks to her brother, imprisoned in Menard Correctional Center, once or twice a week.

"I would love them to put him back in court and resentenced so

he could come out (and see) his family and mother," Hobbs said. "She's not getting any younger."

Last month, the bill, which so far has 27 House Democratic sponsors, passed 7-3 in the House Restorative Justice and Public Safety Committee, an early step in a lengthy legislative process. During the hearing, the bill's main sponsor, Rep. Theresa Mah, testified that the legislation recognizes "children and young people's brain development and

Turn to Sentences, Page 2

Jones was anointed by his powerful father. Now he heads to trial

The Democratic state senator faces federal bribery charges in red-light camera case

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

Chicago Democrat Emil Jones III was made a state senator in 2008 in a classic Illinois way, on a path paved by his powerful father that left little to chance.

Now, Jones is rolling the dice with a federal jury that could send him packing in equally time-honored Illinois fashion: as a convicted felon.

Jones, 46, whose father, Emil Jones Jr., led the state Senate for years before orchestrating having his son replace him, goes on trial Monday on bribery charges alleging he agreed to help a red-light camera company alter legislation in exchange for

\$5,000 and a job for his legislative intern.

While the younger Jones' case lacks the blockbuster billing of the recent trials of Democratic powerhouses like ex-House Speaker Michael Madigan and former Chicago Ald. Edward Burke, it's the first case from the sprawling red-light camera probe to go before a jury, and will feature testimony from FBI mole Omar Maani, a founder and executive at SafeSpeed LLC who has so far avoided the witness stand.

Maani made a number of undercover recordings that will be seen and heard for the first time at Jones' trial. Among them: a video of Jones dining with Maani and then-state Sen. Martin Sandoval, the influential Transportation Committee chair, at Gibson's Steakhouse on Rush Street.

Turn to Jones, Page 4



Greektown celebration

A group from Holy Cross Greek Orthodox Church rides a float during the annual Greek Independence Day Parade on Sunday along South Halsted Street in Greektown in Chicago. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Trump advisers say nations seeking talks

By Adriana Gomez Licon
Associated Press

FORT LAUDERDALE, Fla. — Top administration officials said Sunday that more than 50 countries targeted by President Donald Trump's new tariffs have reached out to begin negotiations over the sweeping import taxes that have sent financial markets reeling, raised fears of a recession and

upended the global trading system.

The higher rates are set to be collected beginning Wednesday, ushering in a new era of economic uncertainty with no clear end in sight. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said unfair trade practices are not "the kind of thing you can negotiate away in days or weeks." The United States, he said, must see "what the countries offer and whether it's believable."

Trump, who spent the weekend in Florida playing golf, posted online that "WE WILL WIN. HANG TOUGH, it won't be easy." His Cabinet members and economic advisers were out in force Sunday defending the tariffs and downplaying the consequences for the global economy.

"There doesn't have to be a

Turn to Trump, Page 8

INSIDE

Israeli military changes story on dead medics

It backtracked on its account of the killing of 15 Palestinian medics after phone video appeared to contradict Israel's claims. **Nation & World**

2 sonic wonders wow full house at Symphony Center

An age-diverse crowd packed the venue Friday for jazz from pianist Hiromi and harpist Brandee Younger, both with their bands. **Arts & Living**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High 40 Low 24

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 10

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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